is set up in a new area.

BUBBLE

The price rise of an asset unexplained by the fundamentals and still people interested in holding the assets. After the bursting of the bubble, assets cool down to their real prices.

BUDGET LINE

A line on the dual axis graph showing the alternate combinations of goods that can be purchased by a consumer with a given income at given prices.

BULLION

Precious metals such as gold, silver, and platinum that are traded in the form of *bars* and *coins* for investment purposes and are used for jewellery as base metals.

BUSINESS CYCLE

See the chapter with the same title.

BUSY & SLACK SEASONS

The monetary authorities face the challenge of keeping the growth rate as high as possible, at the same time putting burden of adjustment on luxury and unproductive consumption. Monetary policy is an instrument in this respect. However, the right policies may not be palatable to the political and fiscal authorities, which is a serious problem for the economy.